

Heidi M. Dains

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I love a blank page, a big idea, and the challenge of figuring out how to make it real. I'm at my best building brands, experiences, partnerships, and campaigns that don't feel like everything else in the room, and I've built my career around refusing to separate great strategy from great creative. I can see the big picture, obsess over the details, rally the right people around an idea, and still care deeply about whether it worked. More than anything, I love making people feel something about a brand, because being noticed is good. Being remembered is better.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Strategic Maintenance Solutions (SMS), Remote

Marketing Manager (Department Lead, Brand Strategy, Growth & Experience)

July 2024 – Present

- Serve as the company's marketing lead across a five-brand portfolio, setting strategy and owning execution across brand, integrated marketing, creative, digital, experiential, partnerships, content, demand generation, and sales enablement.
- Direct approximately \$500K in annual marketing investment and the team of internal and external talent behind it, managing an in-house marketer and leading agencies, designers, production partners, and vendors to turn ambitious ideas into polished, high-impact work.
- Create integrated brand experiences that bring together strategy, storytelling, design, digital, partnerships, and live engagement, building programs that strengthen brand relevance, deepen customer and partner relationships, and create measurable business impact.
- Transformed the company's flagship industry program into a fully integrated brand experience, driving more than 10x YoY growth in qualified leads and establishing a new standard for how the organization approaches experiential marketing, customer engagement, and event-driven growth.
- Built the marketing engine behind the brand, introducing campaign attribution, CRM and digital workflows, UTM governance, SEO and AEO strategy, performance reporting, and scalable processes that gave leadership new visibility into marketing ROI, pipeline contribution, and growth.
- Lead brand transformation at pivotal moments of growth, including building and launching a new brand from the ground up and now directing the end-to-end marketing integration of a corporate acquisition, spanning brand strategy, communications, digital experience, creative, and go-to-market execution.

Ansys, Inc. (acquired by Synopsys), Remote

Channel Marketing Specialist

June 2022 – June 2024

Promoted from Channel Marketing Coordinator

- Developed integrated go-to-market programs with global channel partners, translating corporate strategy into co-branded campaigns, content, digital programs, and experiences aligned with regional growth priorities.
- Shaped partner engagement across major global programs, including CES, international partner summits, and executive experiences, connecting marketing strategy with high-value relationship building, brand presence, and business development.
- Partnered with regional and field marketing teams across global markets, including APAC, providing strategic guidance on campaign execution, partner engagement, and emerging digital practices to strengthen program performance.
- Analyzed campaign, event, and partner performance across global initiatives, translating results into actionable insights for regional teams and senior leadership to inform investment, optimization, and future strategy.

American Eagle Outfitters, Pittsburgh, PA

International Operations Coordinator

March 2020 – April 2022

- Led cross-functional initiatives alongside VP-level leadership across international markets, bringing together merchandising, marketing, and operations to execute retail activations, buying events, brand campaigns, and market expansion initiatives.
- Supported global brand growth across complex launches and retail programs, managing timelines, stakeholder communications, and execution across multiple markets; led the operational relaunch of the brand in Japan.

- Built and led internal communications across 12 operational channels, improving visibility and alignment among teams navigating fast-moving launches and international initiatives.

Project Lead – Urban Necessities, AEO

May 2019 – March 2020

- Managed a \$1M+ budget for American Eagle's partnership with culture-driven sneaker brand Urban Necessities, representing the brand at major national sneaker events while negotiating and sourcing high-value product for retail activation and resale.

UPMC, Pittsburgh, PA

Recruitment Specialist, Contractor

October 2018 – December 2018

- Reviewed, evaluated, and forwarded candidate applications based on objective criteria consistent with the legal requirements, job description, qualifications, and business unit needs.
- Provided consultation and guidance on employment policies, procedures, and legal considerations to all levels of management within assigned departments.

Mylan Pharmaceuticals (now Viatris), Canonsburg, PA

Talent Acquisition Specialist

April 2017 – April 2018

- Managed full-cycle recruiting processes by screening resumes, initiating first-round phone interviews, and creating relationships to determine potential for new hires.
- Tracked and analyzed recruitment metrics to identify areas for improvement, such as time-to-hire, cost-per-hire, and overall candidate experience.

EDUCATION

Waynesburg University

Bachelor of Science in Business Administration

May 2016

Major: Business Management; Minors in Marketing and Communication

SKILLS AND CERTIFICATIONS

Marketing & Brand Leadership – Integrated Marketing Strategy, Brand Strategy & Positioning, Go-to-Market Strategy, Creative Direction, Portfolio Marketing, Acquisition Integration, Campaign Strategy, Demand Generation

Brand Experience & Engagement – Experiential Marketing, Brand Activations, Strategic Partnerships, Partner Marketing, Customer & Executive Engagement, Sponsorship Strategy, Event Marketing, Environmental & Experience Design

Platforms & Creative Technology – HubSpot Marketing Hub & CMS, Salesforce, Google Analytics (GA4), LinkedIn Campaign Manager, Google Ads, Meta Ads Manager, Adobe Creative Cloud, Canva, Figma, HubDB, HTML/CSS, Cvent, Captello, Jiffilenow, Monday.com

Digital, Content & Growth – Digital Marketing, Content Strategy, Web & Landing Page Strategy, Sales Enablement, SEO, Paid Media, Audience Strategy, Lead Generation

Marketing Operations & Analytics – Marketing Attribution, Pipeline & ROI Analysis, Campaign Measurement, CRM Strategy, UTM Strategy, Conversion Tracking, A/B Testing, Marketing Performance Analytics

Certifications – HubSpot Academy (Digital Marketing, SEO, Content Marketing); AI Strategy for Marketers (Independent Coursework); Data Visualization Fundamentals.